

# Neighbourhood Processing



Neighbourhood processing

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# Introduction.

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- ❖ We have seen in chapter 2 that an image can be modified by applying a particular function to each pixel value.
- ❖ Neighbourhood processing may be considered as an extension of this, where a function is applied to a neighbourhood of each pixel.
- ❖ We deal in this chapter with the mask and filter then

## What is the mask and filter???

# Introduction-cont

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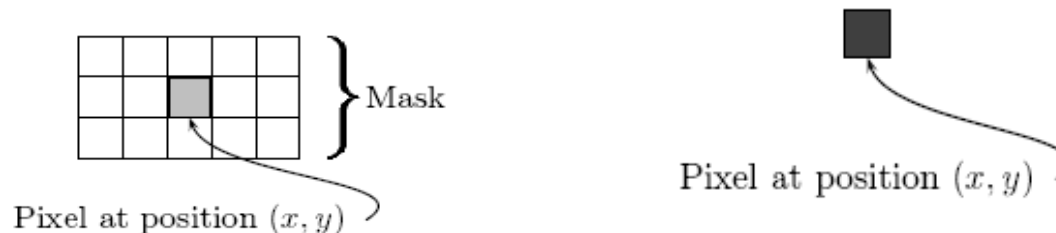
## What is the mask???

Is a rectangle (usually with sides of odd length) or other shape over the given image.

## What is the filter???

The combination of mask and function

- ❖ If the function by which the new grey value is calculated is a linear function of all the grey values in the mask, then the filter is called a linear filter.



# Introduction-cont

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- ❖ *A linear filter* can be implemented by multiplying all elements in the mask by corresponding elements in the neighbourhood, and adding up all these products.
- ❖ **Ex:**
- ❖ **Suppose the mask 3\*5 and it's values:**

|             |             |            |            |            |
|-------------|-------------|------------|------------|------------|
| $m(-1, -2)$ | $m(-1, -1)$ | $m(-1, 0)$ | $m(-1, 1)$ | $m(-1, 2)$ |
| $m(0, -2)$  | $m(0, -1)$  | $m(0, 0)$  | $m(0, 1)$  | $m(0, 2)$  |
| $m(1, -2)$  | $m(1, -1)$  | $m(1, 0)$  | $m(1, 1)$  | $m(1, 2)$  |

# Pixel values

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|               |               |             |               |               |
|---------------|---------------|-------------|---------------|---------------|
| $p(i-1, j-2)$ | $p(i-1, j-1)$ | $p(i-1, j)$ | $p(i-1, j+1)$ | $p(i-1, j+2)$ |
| $p(i, j-2)$   | $p(i, j-1)$   | $p(i, j)$   | $p(i, j+1)$   | $p(i, j+2)$   |
| $p(i+1, j-2)$ | $p(i+1, j-1)$ | $p(i+1, j)$ | $p(i+1, j+1)$ | $p(i+1, j+2)$ |

We now multiply and add:

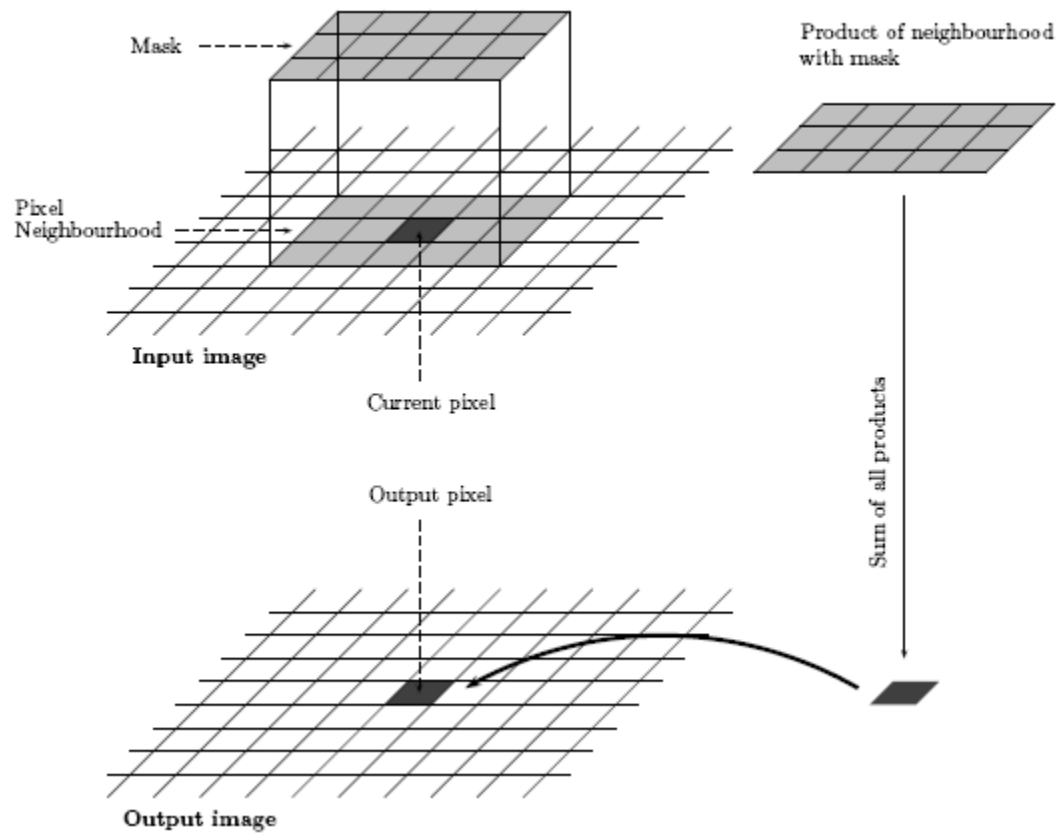
$$\sum_{s=-1}^1 \sum_{t=-2}^2 m(s, t) p(i + s, j + t).$$

# What is the steps of Spatial filtering?

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- 1) position the mask over the current pixel.**
- 2) form all products of filter elements with the corresponding elements of the neighbourhood.**
- 3) add up all the products.**





# Example:

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**Consider 3\*3 mask we can do linear filter by take the average of all values in the mask.**

|     |     |     |
|-----|-----|-----|
|     |     |     |
| $a$ | $b$ | $c$ |
| $d$ | $e$ | $f$ |
| $g$ | $h$ | $i$ |
|     |     |     |

$$\rightarrow \frac{1}{9}(a + b + c + d + e + f + g + h + i)$$

# To apply this in mat lab write:

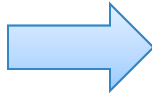
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```
>> x=uint8(10*magic(5))
```

x =

|     |     |     |     |     |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 170 | 240 | 10  | 80  | 150 |
| 230 | 50  | 70  | 140 | 160 |
| 40  | 60  | 130 | 200 | 220 |
| 100 | 120 | 190 | 210 | 30  |
| 110 | 180 | 250 | 20  | 90  |



|     |     |     |     |     |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 170 | 240 | 10  | 80  | 150 |
| 230 | 50  | 70  | 140 | 160 |
| 40  | 60  | 130 | 200 | 220 |
| 100 | 120 | 190 | 210 | 30  |
| 110 | 180 | 250 | 20  | 90  |

```
>> mean2(x(1:3,1:3))
```

ans =

111.1111

# Notation

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- ❖ We can describe linear filter simply in terms of the coefficients of all the grey values of pixels within the mask.
- ❖ EX: the filter

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 1 \\ -2 & 4 & -2 \\ 1 & -2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

would operate on grey values as

|     |     |     |
|-----|-----|-----|
|     |     |     |
| $a$ | $b$ | $c$ |
| $d$ | $e$ | $f$ |
| $g$ | $h$ | $i$ |
|     |     |     |

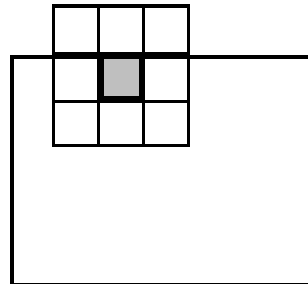
 $\longrightarrow a - 2b + c - 2d + 4e - 2d + g - 2h + i$

# Edges of the image

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- ❖ **There is an obvious problem in applying a filter**
- ❖ **what happens at the edge of the image, where the mask partly falls outside the image???**



# Solutions:

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## 1) Ignore the edges:

- the mask is only applied to those pixels in the image for which the mask will lie fully within the image
- As the result of this output image is smaller than the original.
- If the mask is very large, a significant amount of information may be lost by this method.

## 2) Pad with zeros:

- all values outside the image are zero.
- output image of the same size as the original.
- But it may consider unwanted artifacts like edges around the image

# Filtering in Matlab:

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- ❖ **The filter2 function does the job of linear filtering:**  
**filter2(filter, image, shape)**
- ❖ **filter2(filter, image, 'same')** is the default it produces a matrix of equal size to the original image matrix. It uses zero padding:

```
>> a=ones(3,3)/9

a =

    0.1111    0.1111    0.1111
    0.1111    0.1111    0.1111
    0.1111    0.1111    0.1111

>> filter2(a,x,'same')

ans =

    76.6667    85.5556    65.5556    67.7778    58.8889
    87.7778   111.1111   108.8889   128.8889   105.5556
    66.6667   110.0000   130.0000   150.0000   106.6667
    67.7778   131.1111   151.1111   148.8889    85.5556
    56.6667   105.5556   107.7778    87.7778    38.8889
```



```
>> filter2(a,x,'valid')
```

```
ans =
```

|          |          |          |
|----------|----------|----------|
| 111.1111 | 108.8889 | 128.8889 |
| 110.0000 | 130.0000 | 150.0000 |
| 131.1111 | 151.1111 | 148.8889 |

**filter2(filter,image,'valid')** applies the mask only to inside pixels.  
The result will always be smaller than the original:



```
>> filter2(a,x,'full')
```

```
ans =
```

|         |         |          |          |          |          |         |
|---------|---------|----------|----------|----------|----------|---------|
| 18.8889 | 45.5556 | 46.6667  | 36.6667  | 26.6667  | 25.5556  | 16.6667 |
| 44.4444 | 76.6667 | 85.5556  | 65.5556  | 67.7778  | 58.8889  | 34.4444 |
| 48.8889 | 87.7778 | 111.1111 | 108.8889 | 128.8889 | 105.5556 | 58.8889 |
| 41.1111 | 66.6667 | 110.0000 | 130.0000 | 150.0000 | 106.6667 | 45.5556 |
| 27.7778 | 67.7778 | 131.1111 | 151.1111 | 148.8889 | 85.5556  | 37.7778 |
| 23.3333 | 56.6667 | 105.5556 | 107.7778 | 87.7778  | 38.8889  | 13.3333 |
| 12.2222 | 32.2222 | 60.0000  | 50.0000  | 40.0000  | 12.2222  | 10.0000 |

**filter2(filter,image,'full')**

returns a result larger than the original





## Another approach to create filter.

*Ex:* use spatial function to create average filter

```
fspecial('average',[5,7])
```

```
fspecial('average',11)
```

```
fspecial('average' )
```



```
>> c=imread('cameraman.tif');  
>> f1=fspecial('average');  
>> cf1=filter2(f1,c);
```

**To display the image we should follow steps:**

- 1. Convert image to the type uint8.**
- 2. Divide all values on 255.**
- 3. Apply (mat2gray) to scale the result for display:**

**figure,imshow(c),figure,imshow(cf1/255)**



*Original image*



*Average filtering*



*Using a  $9 \times 9$  filter*



*Using a  $25 \times 25$  filter*

# Separable filters

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**Some filters can be implemented by the successive application of two simpler filters.**

**Ex:**

$$\frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \frac{1}{3} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{3} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

The 3\*3 averaging filter is thus separable into two smaller filters.

separately can result in great time savings.



**for each pixel in the image.**

**$n \times n$  filter requires  $n^2$  multiplications, and  $n^2 - 1$  additions.**

**an  $n \times 1$  filter only requires  $n$  multiplications and  $n - 1$  additions.**

**So, the total number of multiplications  $2n$  and  $2n - 2$  additions.**

# Separable filters-cont

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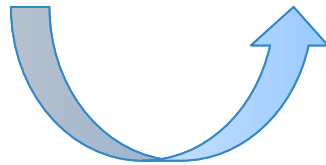
❖ Ex

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 1 \\ -2 & 4 & -2 \\ 1 & -2 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -2 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

3\*3

3\*1

1\*3



# Frequencies low and high pass Filters.

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There Is some Aspects Of An Image That aim Us To use appropriate Filter for a given image processing task.

- ❖ One important aspect of an image Is:: frequencies
- ❖ Frequency is measure Of Amount By Which Gray Value Change With Distance
  - 1) High frequency components are characterized by large changes in grey values over small distances.  
Example edges and noise.
  - 2) Low frequency components are parts of the image characterized by little change in the grey values.  
Example backgrounds, skin textures.

# Frequencies low and high pass Filters.

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❖ We then say that a Filter is ::

1) **High pass Filter** if it “passes over” the high frequency components, and reduces or eliminates low frequency components.

-- Example : laplacian Filter. Used For Edge Detection And Edge Enhancement.

2) **Low pass Filter** if it “passes over” the low frequency components, and reduces or eliminates high frequency components.

-- Example : Averaging Filter. Used To Blure Edges.



# Frequencies low and high pass Filters.(Cont)



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**Note**

**The sum of the coefficients (that is, the sum of all elements in the matrix), in the high pass Filter is**

**Laplacian Filter**  $\rightarrow$  
$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 1 \\ -2 & 4 & -2 \\ 1 & -2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

❖ **Apply the above high pass Filter to:**

|     |     |     |     |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 150 | 152 | 148 | 149 |
| 147 | 152 | 151 | 150 |
| 152 | 148 | 149 | 151 |
| 151 | 149 | 150 | 148 |

$\rightarrow$

|     |    |
|-----|----|
| 11  | 6  |
| -13 | -5 |

$\rightarrow$  **The resulting values are close to zero.**

**Using Camera Man Image Do This In Matlab g Camera Man Image Do This In Matlab**

# Laplacian Filter

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```
>> f=fspecial('laplacian')
```

```
f =
```

|        |         |        |
|--------|---------|--------|
| 0.1667 | 0.6667  | 0.1667 |
| 0.6667 | -3.3333 | 0.6667 |
| 0.1667 | 0.6667  | 0.1667 |

```
>> cf=filter2(f,c);
```

```
>> imshow(cf/100)
```

```
>> f1=fspecial('log')
```

```
f1 =
```

|        |        |         |        |        |
|--------|--------|---------|--------|--------|
| 0.0448 | 0.0468 | 0.0564  | 0.0468 | 0.0448 |
| 0.0468 | 0.3167 | 0.7146  | 0.3167 | 0.0468 |
| 0.0564 | 0.7146 | -4.9048 | 0.7146 | 0.0564 |
| 0.0468 | 0.3167 | 0.7146  | 0.3167 | 0.0468 |
| 0.0448 | 0.0468 | 0.0564  | 0.0468 | 0.0448 |

```
>> cf1=filter2(f1,c);
```

```
>> figure,imshow(cf1/100)
```

# High Pass Filter

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Laplacian Filter



Laplacian of Gaussian (log) Filtering

# Values outside the range 0-255

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- ❖ **The result of applying a linear Filter may be values which lie outside The range 0-255 We consider dealing with This values.**
  - ✓ **Make negative values positive.**
  - ✓ **Clip values. We apply the following thresholding:**

$$y = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } x < 0 \\ x & \text{if } 0 \leq x \leq 255 \\ 255 & \text{if } x > 255 \end{cases}$$

It is not suitable if there are many grey values outside the 0-255 rang

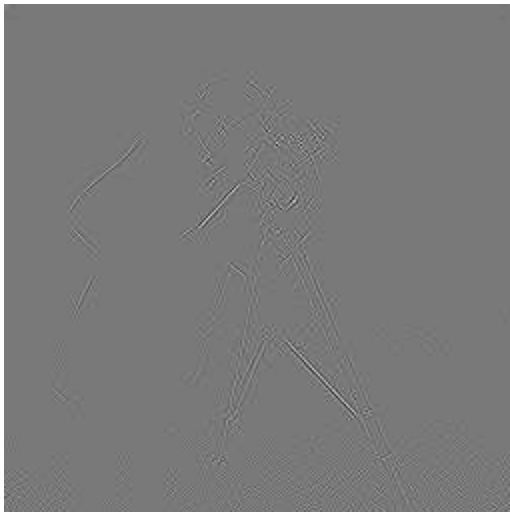
# Values outside the range 0-255.(Cont)

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## ❖ Example: Using a high pass Filter and displaying the result

```
>> f2=[1 -2 1;-2 4 -2;1 -2 1];  
>> cf2=filter2(f2,c);  
  
>> figure,imshow(mat2gray(cf2));  
  
>> figure,imshow(cf2/60)
```



**Using mat2gray**



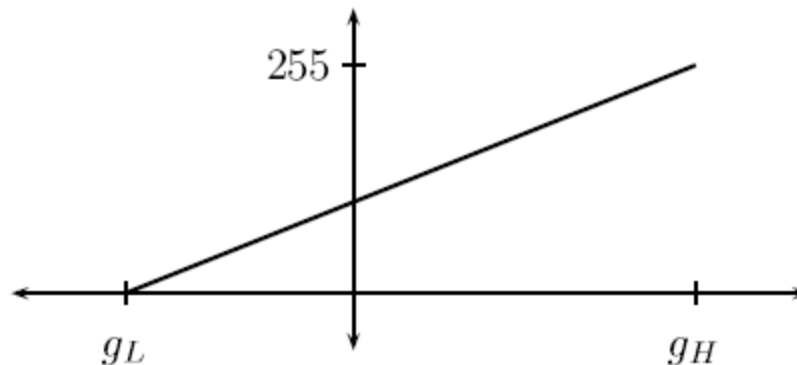
**Dividing by a constant**

# Scaling transformation

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- Lowest grey value produced by the Filter  $g_L$ .
- Highest value is  $g_H$ .
- We can transform all values in the range  $g_L$ - $g_H$  by Linear Transformation.



$$y = 255 \frac{x - g_L}{g_H - g_L}$$

# Edge sharpening

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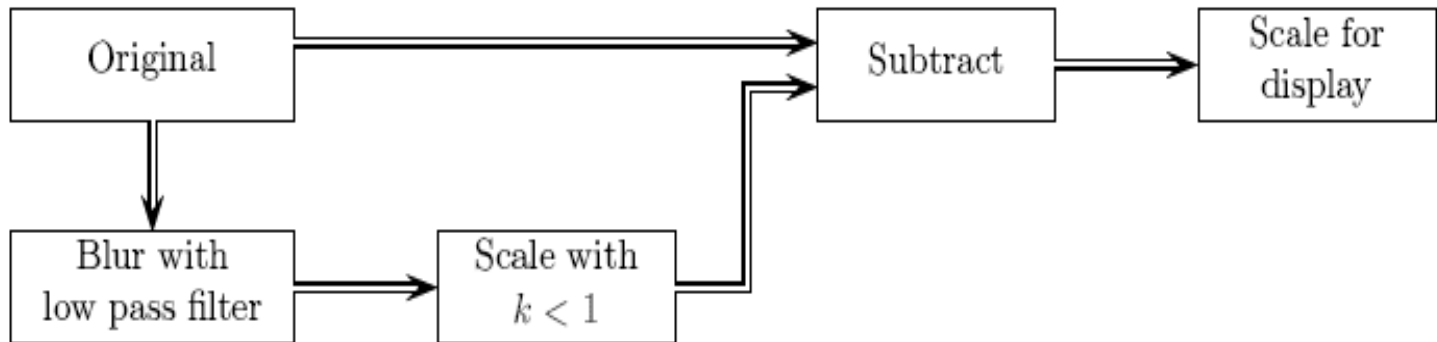


- ❖ can be used to make edges in an image slightly sharper and crisper, which generally results in an image more pleasing to the human eye.

**This Operation Called :**

- ❖ **Edge enhancement = Edge crispening = unsharp masking.**

**Unsharp masking**



**Schema for unsharp masking**



# Edge sharpening.(Cont)

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- ❖ **EX: Suppose an image is of type uint8. The unsharp masking can be applied by the following sequence of commands:**

```
>> f=fspecial('average');  
>> xf=filter2(f,x);  
>> xu=double(x)-xf/1.5  
>> imshow(xu/70)
```





# Edge sharpening.(Cont)

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- ❖ We can in fact perform the Filtering and subtracting operation in one command By :  
using the linearity of the Filter, and that the 3\*3 Filter.

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

identity Filter

**K: Constant  
To Provide  
Best Result**

$$f = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} - \frac{1}{k} \begin{bmatrix} 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \\ 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \\ 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \end{bmatrix} \quad f = k \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} - \begin{bmatrix} 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \\ 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \\ 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \end{bmatrix}$$

unsharp masking can be implemented by a Filter of the form

# Edge sharpening.(Cont)

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- ❖ The unsharp option of fspecial produces such Filters the Filter created has the form:

$$\frac{1}{\alpha+1} \begin{bmatrix} -\alpha & \alpha-1 & -\alpha \\ \alpha-1 & \alpha+5 & \alpha-1 \\ -\alpha & \alpha-1 & -\alpha \end{bmatrix}$$

**$\alpha$ : an optional parameter Its defaults = 0.2**

If  $\alpha = 0.5$

$$\frac{1}{3} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & -1 & -1 \\ -1 & 11 & -1 \\ -1 & -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = 4 \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} - 3 \begin{bmatrix} 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \\ 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \\ 1/9 & 1/9 & 1/9 \end{bmatrix}$$

using the Matlab commands

```
>> p=imread('pelicans.tif');  
>> u=fspecial('unsharp',0.5);  
>> pu=filter2(u,p);  
>> imshow(p),figure,imshow(pu/255)
```

# Edge enhancement with unsharp masking

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**The original**



**After unsharp masking**

# High boost filtering

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Allied to unsharp masking Filters are the high boost Filters, which are obtained by:

$$\text{high boost} = A(\text{original}) - (\text{low pass}).$$

**Special Case:** If **A=1** the high boost Filter becomes an ordinary high pass Filter

If we take as the low pass Filter the 3\*3 Averaging Filter

$$\frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & -1 & -1 \\ -1 & z & -1 \\ -1 & -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

If we put **Z=11** we obtain a Filtering very similar to the unsharp Filter, except for a scaling factor

```
>> f=[-1 -1 -1;-1 11 -1;-1 -1 -1]/9;  
>> xf=filter2(x,f);  
>> imshow(xf/80)
```

# High boost filtering (Cont)

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**Note**

We can also write the high boost formula as:

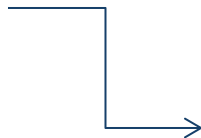
$$\begin{aligned}\text{high boost} &= A(\text{original}) - (\text{low pass}) \\ &= A(\text{original}) - ((\text{original}) - (\text{high pass})) \\ &= (A - 1)(\text{original}) + (\text{high pass}).\end{aligned}$$

❖ **Best results for high boost Filtering are obtained if we multiply the equation by a factor ( W )**

$$wA - w = 1$$

or

$$w = \frac{1}{A - 1}.$$



So a general unsharp masking formula is

$$\frac{A}{A - 1}(\text{original}) - \frac{1}{A - 1}(\text{low pass}).$$

Another version of this formula is

$$\frac{A}{2A - 1}(\text{original}) - \frac{1 - A}{2A - 1}(\text{low pass})$$

where for best results  $A$  is taken so that

$$\frac{3}{5} \leq A \leq \frac{5}{6}.$$



If we take  $A = 3/5$ , the formula becomes

$$\frac{3/5}{2(3/5) - 1}(\text{original}) - \frac{1 - (3/5)}{2(3/5) - 1}(\text{low pass}) = 3(\text{original}) - 2(\text{low pass})$$

If we take  $A = 5/6$  we obtain

$$\frac{5}{4}(\text{original}) - \frac{1}{4}(\text{low pass})$$

```
>> id=[0 0 0;0 1 0;0 0 0];
>> f=fspecial('average');
>> hb1=3*id-2*f

hb1 =

    -0.2222    -0.2222    -0.2222
    -0.2222     2.7778    -0.2222
    -0.2222    -0.2222    -0.2222

>> hb2=1.25*id-0.25*f

hb2 =

    -0.0278    -0.0278    -0.0278
    -0.0278     1.2222    -0.0278
    -0.0278    -0.0278    -0.0278
```





❖ To show these results:

```
x1=filter2(hb1,x); imshow(x1/255)
```

```
x2=filter2(hb2,x);imshow(x2/255)
```

**High boost  
Filtering**



**High boost Filtering with hb1**



**High boost filtering with hb2**

*The Result Of Filter, hb1 appears to produce the best result Than hb2*

# Non-linear Filters

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- ❖ **A non-linear Filter is obtained by a non-linear function of the grayscale values in the mask.**

## Examples

- 1) ***Rank-order Filters:*** the elements under the mask are ordered.
  - a) **maximum Filter:** its output the maximum value under the mask.
  - b) **minimum Filter:** its output the minimum value under the mask.

If the values are given in increasing order, the minimum Filter is a rank-order Filter for which *the First element* is returned, and the maximum Filter is a rank-order Filter for which *the last element* is returned.

- 2) ***Geometric mean Filter.***



# Implementing *Rank-order Filters* in Mat lab

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❖ The function is ( `nlfilter` )

**Ex: First to implement a maximum Filter over 3\*3 neighborhood:**

```
>> cmax=nlfilter(c,[3,3],'max(x(:))');
```



Using a maximum Filter

```
>> cmin=nlfilter(c,[3,3],'min(x(:))');
```



Using a minimum Filter



- ❖ In each case the image has lost some sharpness, and has been brightened by the maximum Filter, Darkened by the minimum Filter.

**The `nlfilter` function is very slow.**

A faster alternative is to use the (`colfilt`) function, which

**Ex:** rearranges the image into columns First.

```
>> cmax=colfilt(c,[3,3],'sliding',@max);
```

The parameter `sliding` indicates that overlapping neighborhoods are being used.

# Implement the max and min Filters as rank-order Filters

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- ❖ The function Is ( `ordfilt2` ) .
- ❖ This requires three inputs Parameters:
  - 1) The image,
  - 2) The index value of the ordered results to choose as output,
  - 3) The definition of the mask.

Ex:

```
>> cmax=ordfilt2(c,9,ones(3,3));
```

```
>> cmin=ordfilt2(c,1,ones(3,3));
```

```
>> cmed=ordfilt2(c,5,ones(3,3));
```

**The Max  
Filter**

**The Min  
Filter**

**The  
Median  
Filter**

# Geometric mean Filter

12/3/2025



❖ **It's another non-linear Filters which is defined as:**

$$\left( \prod_{(i,j) \in M} x(i,j) \right)^{(1/|M|)}$$

**M:Filter  
Mask  
|M|:Its  
Size**

## Alpha-Trimmed Mean Filter Steps:

- 1) Orders the values under the mask.
- 2) Trims Off elements at either end of the ordered list.
- 3) Takes the mean of the remainder.

**Ex:**

$$x_1 \leq x_2 \leq x_3 \leq \dots \leq x_9$$

and trim off two elements at either end, the result of the filter will be

$$(x_3 + x_4 + x_5 + x_6 + x_7)/5.$$



# Thank You